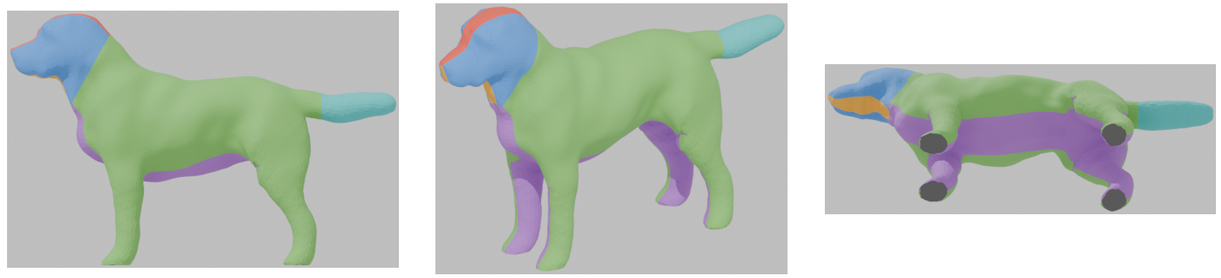
Labrador, standing: seam layout v2

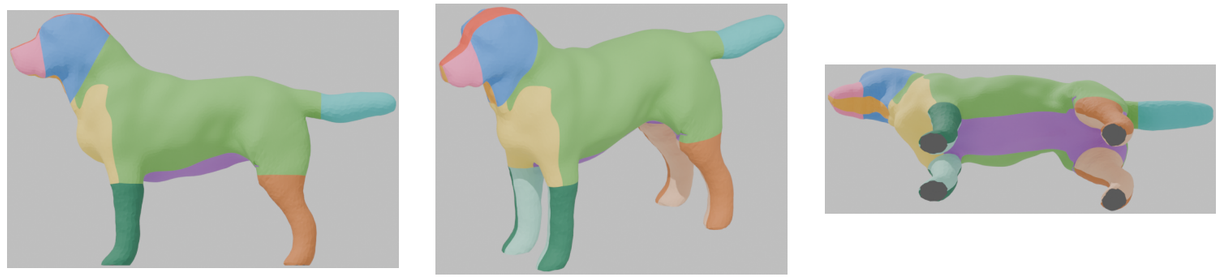
PROPOSAL FOR APPROVAL

Medium size: 350 mm nose to tail base. Drawn on base shape v0.4. 31 Oct 2026. Not for cutting: please answer the questions on the right and send them back.

Current layout v1: 20 pieces



Proposed layout v2: 29 pieces

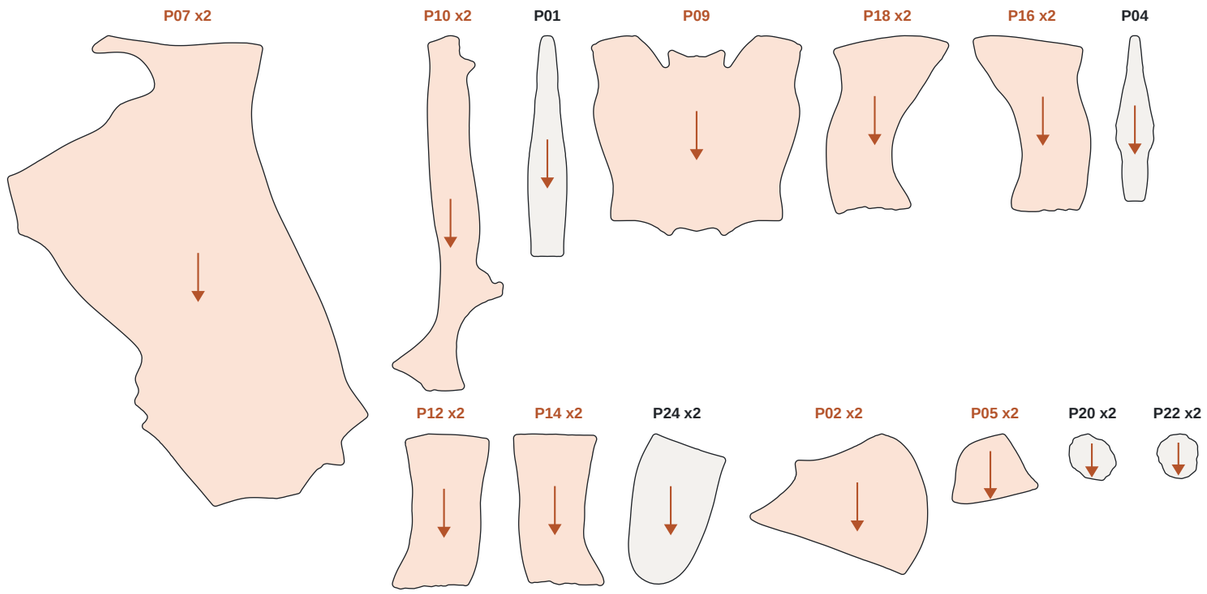


v2 colours

- P01 head gusset
- P02/03 side head
- P04 chin gusset
- P05/06 muzzle side
- P07/08 body side
- P09 chest bib
- P10/11 belly
- P12/13 front leg outer
- P14/15 front leg inner
- P16/17 hind leg outer
- P18/19 hind leg inner
- P20-23 paw pads
- P24/25 tail
- P26-29 ears (flat, not shown)

v2 pieces at one scale (right-hand and centre pieces; x2 = cut a mirrored left piece too). Arrow = pile direction.

Outlines are indicative: seam lines are faired, notched and checked in the v2 pattern after approval.



Drawn at about 1:4.0 of the medium plush. Shaded = new or changed pieces. Names: see v2 colours above.

What changes, and why

1. **Legs are separate pieces below the elbow and the stifle (knee).**
   An outer and an inner piece per leg, cut with the pile running down. In v1 the legs were part of the body side and belly pieces, so the leg fur ran sideways: 61 % of the leg area more than 30 degrees off.
2. **Chest bib over the chest and the fronts of the shoulders, down to the elbows.**
   Pile runs down, as on a Labrador's chest. In v1 it ran towards the tail (90 % off).
3. **Belly in two halves, centre seam underneath.**
   A one-piece belly stretches about 22 % between the hind legs; two halves stay under 9 %. The seam is hidden underneath.
4. **Muzzle side pieces: seam from the stop, in front of the eye, to the corner of the mouth.**
   Gives a sharper stop and fuller cheeks, and a natural place to set the eye. The lighter option is to keep the v1 side head and add a dart at the stop (question 3).
5. **Darts instead of easing at the hips, shoulders, tail root and tail tip.**
   v1 needs up to 5 mm of easing in 40 mm of seam in places (armpits, neck, hips). Where v2 still needs more than about 3 mm, it gets a dart instead; exact positions come with the v2 pattern.
6. **Ears: a small pleat at the base so the ear turns forward and frames the face, as in the photos.**
7. **Unchanged: head gusset, chin gusset, body sides with the centre-back seam, two-piece tail.**

Fur direction check

Share of each area where the pile, once sewn, points more than 30 degrees away from a Labrador's coat direction. Lower is better.

Area	v1 now	v2
Head	3 %	4 %
Body sides	9 %	7 %
Chest and shoulder fronts	**90 %**	4 %
Legs	**61 %**	7 %
Belly and inner thighs (underneath)	**42 %**	**21 %**
Tail	9 %	6 %

Cost

20 pieces become 29. Total seam length at medium size goes from 3.8 m to 4.4 m (about 16 % more sewing). Fabric for the body pieces (ears are the same in both), seam allowance included: 2,165 cm2 to 2,241 cm2 (+4 %).

Questions for the workshop

1. Separate leg pieces (outer and inner, joined at the elbow and the stifle): OK? Or do you prefer another way to make the leg fur run down?
   ☐ Yes ☐ No Comments: _____
2. Chest bib over the chest and the fronts of the shoulders: OK?
   ☐ Yes ☐ No Comments: _____
3. Head: A) muzzle side pieces as shown, or B) keep the v1 side head with a dart at the stop?
   ☐ A ☐ B Comments: _____
4. Darts instead of easing: OK? What is the most easing you are happy with in 40 mm of seam?
   ☐ Yes ☐ No Comments: _____
5. Paw pads come out about 26 mm across at medium, just over the 25 mm smallest-piece default. Keep them as separate pads (in short pile or suede?), or close the leg end with a dart?
   ☐ Pads ☐ Dart Comments: _____
6. Ears: is a pleat at the base OK? (Lining in the same fur or a short pile? Please say in the comments.)
   ☐ Yes ☐ No Comments: _____
7. Do you already make a realistic dog you are happy with? Photos of its pattern pieces would help us.
   ☐ Yes ☐ No Comments: _____

Defaults until you confirm them: seam allowance 5 mm; narrowest turnable tube 25 mm; tightest curve 3 mm; smallest piece 25 mm; roll width 1500 mm; laser files DXF in mm, cut and notch on separate layers (RDWorks / LightBurn). Fabric: knitted polyester backing, acrylic pile; one white stock fur per plush, trimmed to the trim map; pieces laid at 0 or 180 degrees only.